THE SI SENTINEL

Weekday briefing on builders shaping super intelligence

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

Windows becomes an agent box, three labs ship in one hour, and the locks start to look weaker

Wednesday was a launch day. In San Francisco, Satya Nadella and Jensen Huang rebuilt Windows around AI agents that run on the PC, on new Nvidia RTX Spark laptops that ship October 16. Within the same 2:00 p.m. EDT hour, OpenAI put GPT-6 and a new "Intelligent UI" in front of every ChatGPT user and Anthropic released Claude Haiku 5.5 at a tenth of its old price. Elon Musk, who posted about 69 times, said most Grok Bot requests will go to a fast version of Grok 4.8 once it is out.

The math story from earlier in the week kept spreading. Noam Brown argued that models have just crossed above top human experts on some research problems, François Chollet pointed to old evidence that training in one hard domain does not make humans smarter in general, and Vitalik Buterin warned that AI-accelerated math could weaken the cryptography behind the internet. Paul Graham read Amazon's blocking of AI shopping agents as the first real opening for an Amazon competitor in decades. In orbit, the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) cleared 15,000 next-generation Starlink phone satellites, and Musk blamed Indian "oligarchs" for keeping Starlink out of India. 24 of the 42 builders posted.

I · PERSONAL COMPUTERS

"Windows becomes your secure agent box"

Microsoft and Nvidia bet that the next wave of AI runs partly on the desk, not only in the data center, and that the operating system's job is to keep agents in a safe box.

137B	256K	1 PF	$2,599
Parameters in MAI-Code-1.1 Flash, with 6.8B active per token, now runnable on a laptop	Tokens of context supported locally on the new Windows agent stack	One petaflop of AI compute in Nvidia's RTX Spark	Starting price of Surface Laptop Ultra with RTX Spark

Satya Nadella @satyanadella · CEO, Microsoft

At 2:00 p.m. EDT, Microsoft's CEO summed up the event in one long post. The pitch is "unmetered intelligence": instead of paying per token for every request to a cloud model, much of the work runs on the PC itself, with the cloud used only when a task needs a bigger model.

> *"Today marks a new chapter for Windows, as we bring unmetered intelligence to every desk and every home, and make every PC a place where agents can work securely on your behalf… Your PC becomes an infinite software factory… Windows becomes your secure agent box!"*
>
> SATYA NADELLA · @SATYANADELLA · POST

His list: MAI-Code-1.1 Flash, Microsoft's own coding model, optimized to run on the PC; GitHub Copilot handing work off to local models "without sacrificing quality"; Copilot taking action directly on the PC while keeping sensitive work on the device, which Microsoft calls Hybrid Intelligence; "Code in Copilot," for building software on the desktop "without any cloud token spend"; and Agent 365 tied into Windows with a local sandbox for agents. According to Nvidia's account, that sandbox, Microsoft Execution Containers (MXC), is now generally available and lets agents run in the background under operating-system control. Microsoft's developer post says Copilot will decide by itself which tasks stay on the device and which go to the cloud, starting later this month. In one demo reported by Tom's Hardware, a complex request went to

OpenAI's GPT-6 Luna in the cloud while helper agents ran locally.

Jensen Huang @JensenHuang · CEO, Nvidia

Nvidia's founder replied to Nadella that evening with a short history of the partnership, from Windows to graphics chips to the Azure supercomputers that trained GPT:

> *"Windows sparked a platform shift that created a new industry for NVIDIA. Then we invented programmable shading GPUs for DirectX, which led to CUDA. Then we partnered to bring GPU supercomputers to Azure, which helped OpenAI train GPT. That collaboration inspired us to reinvent Windows for the age of personal agents. 4 years. Thousands of engineering years between us."*
> JENSEN HUANG · @JENSENHUANG · POST

(A graphics processing unit, or GPU, is the chip; CUDA is Nvidia's software layer for programming it.) Nadella answered: "Thanks so much Jensen for the deep partnership through all these shifts and now we're maybe on to the biggest!" On stage, according to Tom's Hardware, Huang put it more bluntly: "We've reinvented the personal computer completely." RTX Spark pairs an Nvidia Blackwell graphics chip with a Grace processor; Nvidia also previewed a DGX Station for Windows, a deskside machine with 748 GB of memory that it says can run models up to a trillion parameters.

OPEN SOURCE ON STAGE

Clément Delangue spots llama.cpp in the keynote

Clément Delangue (@ClementDelangue), CEO of Hugging Face, posted a slide from the launch: "If you need any more evidence about how exciting local AI (and llamacpp) is!" llama.cpp is the open-source engine for running models on ordinary hardware; Microsoft says its local coding model runs on a CUDA build of it.

QUICK HIT

Lisa Su @LisaSu, CEO of Advanced Micro Devices, wrapped a visit to Korea with customers and partners "as we grow the open AI ecosystem."

II · MODELS & PRICES

GPT-6 for everyone, a ten-cent Haiku, and the router wars

Inside one hour, the two biggest independent labs shipped. The price of a good-enough answer keeps falling, and assistants are learning to pick the right model for each job.

1.2B	$0.10	~75%	<1%
Weekly ChatGPT users now getting GPT-6, per OpenAI	Claude Haiku 5.5 price per million input tokens, for prompts under 100,000 tokens	Average running-cost cut versus Claude Haiku 4.5, per Anthropic	Cost River AI claims for tuned open models that beat frontier models on one task

Sam Altman and Greg Brockman @sama · CEO, OpenAI · @gdb · president, OpenAI

OpenAI's announcement brought GPT-6 into the regular Chat tab: GPT-6 Sol for paying tiers from Wednesday, and the smaller GPT-6 Luna for free users from Thursday. The headline feature is Intelligent UI (user interface): instead of only paragraphs, ChatGPT can answer with charts, diagrams, buttons, forms, maps and small working tools, such as a bill splitter or a retirement calculator, built on the spot. The models behind Codex and ChatGPT Work are not changing in this release.

> *"ChatGPT can now generate a custom UI for you!" … "Have been waiting for this one for a long time, and I would hate to have to go back to the old version of Chat!"*
> SAM ALTMAN · @SAMA · POST AND FOLLOW-UP

Brockman called it "a new capability in ChatGPT for answering quickly with fully interactive user interfaces." According to The Verge, OpenAI says GPT-6 also searches the web better, gives partial answers while it keeps looking, and resists attempts to get around its safety training more strongly.

Tom Brown @NotTomBrown · co-founder, Anthropic

Four minutes before OpenAI's post, Anthropic announced Claude Haiku 5.5: "the cheapest, fastest, and most capable small model we've ever released," costing around 75% less to run than Haiku 4.5. For prompts under 100,000 tokens, which Anthropic says were about 90% of its old Haiku's traffic, it charges $0.10 per million input tokens and $0.50 per million output tokens, a tenth of the old price; longer prompts cost five times more. It is the first Haiku with adjustable effort, and Anthropic also halved cache-read prices on Claude Sonnet 5.5. Tom Brown quoted the launch with three words: "Small but mighty!" Elon Musk replied to Anthropic: "Congrats on another great model!"

Elon Musk on routing @elonmusk · CEO of SpaceX and Tesla

On Tuesday, Musk said Grok Bot would use whichever back-end model gives the best result, including rivals like Claude Opus 5.5, Midjourney and Suno. On Wednesday he filled in the

rule. Quoting Robert Scoble's "Grok goes open. Holy shit," he wrote that "Simple questions will route to small, fast models. Questions with complex answers will route to large models." Then, quoting Min Choi's summary that "Best model wins":

> *"However, most @Bot requests are pretty simple and will be handled by a lightning-fast version of Grok 4.8 when that comes out. Operating principle is to give Grok Bot users the best possible combination of speed & intelligence."*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

He quoted investor Farzad's August argument that Grok Bot should be "completely model agnostic" and focus on being "the greatest orchestrator AI of all time" with: "Whatever it take for @Bot to deliver the best product experience for users."

Igor Babuschkin, via Clément Delangue

The open-weight camp made its own price argument. River AI, founded by xAI co-founder Igor Babuschkin, released its first open "recipe": open models trained for text-to-SQL (turning plain questions into database queries) that it says beat GPT-6 Astra Pro and Claude Opus 5.5 on one benchmark "for less than 1% of the cost." Babuschkin: "A few years from now most of the LLM usage in the world will run on customized open weight models... Our mission is to help everyone own their own intelligence and be independent of big AI labs." (LLM means large language model.) Clément Delangue replied: "Let's go!"

QUICK HIT

Tom Brown @NotTomBrown on Claude Haiku 5.5: "Small but mighty!" Musk replied: "Congrats on another great model!"

QUICK HIT

Joe Gebbia @jgebbia promoted Lulu Cheng Meservey's October 27 talk on persuasion in San Francisco: "Not to be missed."

A NOTE OF RESTRAINT

Guillermo Rauch: agents will drill forever

Guillermo Rauch (@rauchg), CEO of Vercel, warned that every program can be hardened and optimized "basically ad infinitum." "Even in an infinite token world, you need to know when to stop and what tradeoffs to accept. Agents will happily drill no matter what."

III · FRONTIER SCIENCE

Above the line: what the math surge means

A day after OpenAI's 722 math manuscripts, the builders argued over why it felt so sudden, whether it generalizes, and what it could break.

Noam Brown @polynoamial · reasoning researcher, OpenAI

Mark Chen, OpenAI's chief research officer, wrote that the September Navier-Stokes result was "always much more about the figure below than about the Navier-Stokes problem itself. The run represents a decade of mathematical progress in a week," and said he can't wait to point these tools "at life sciences, building our next models, and alignment!" (In September OpenAI claimed a computer-checked proof that a smooth fluid pushed by a smooth outside force can blow up in finite time; critics say the forced version sidesteps the physically central question.) Noam Brown quoted Chen with the clearest explanation of the moment:

> ***LLMs have crossed an important threshold: surpassing top human experts on some research problems... in scientific discovery there is a big difference between a model just below top human performance and one just above it. That helps explain why the surge in math results feels so sudden.***
>
> NOAM BROWN · @polynoamial · October 7, 2026

He added that capabilities "remain jagged, and there are many ways they are still worse than humans," but expects breakthroughs in other fields to follow.

François Chollet @fchollet · creator of Keras, co-founder of the ARC Prize

Chollet had asked on Monday whether the frontier is "mainly math + code," which can be pushed far with reinforcement learning from verifiable rewards (RLVR), while everything else plateaus. Google researcher Christian Szegedy answered that

"Mathematical reasoning will transfer to any area that requires reasoning… Superhuman intelligence is here." Chollet replied that this rests on two assumptions: that math tactics transfer at all ("perhaps you can learn to do math in a non generalizing way (much like for chess)"), and that other fields are bottlenecked by that kind of reasoning ("Maybe physics?"). Then he brought humans in as evidence:

> *"In the 80s, the 'cognitive consequences of programming' was a major psychological research focus… Students who learn programming become highly proficient at algorithmic thinking and coding, but these gains do not transfer to general cognitive tasks… General intelligence seems to be a fundamental property of the brain rather than a skill you can train."*
>
> FRANÇOIS CHOLLET · @FCHOLLET · POST

Yann LeCun and Jim Fan @ylecun · chief scientist, AMI Labs · @DrJimFan · robotics lead, Nvidia

When French physicist Florent Krzakala mourned that "part of mathematics died today, or maybe yesterday," Yann LeCun answered in French, translated here: "On the contrary. A new era is opening for mathematics. An era where formal proof is largely automated and the emphasis shifts to developing new concepts, new abstractions, new definitions, and new conjectures. The invention of the boat reduced the importance of swimming, but allowed the discovery of new lands." Answering Garry Kasparov's "Atrophy is a choice," he said chess, Go and some pure math are already "gyms of the mind." Jim Fan argued the hard part is elsewhere: "humanity will solve the Riemann hypothesis before we pass the Physical Turing Test," meaning a robot that cleans up after a party so well you can't tell it wasn't a person. "We are not Moravec's paradox-pilled enough." LeCun also noted that the lead authors of RoboJEPA, a new Meta paper showing scaling laws for robot world models, "are now at AMI Labs."

Vitalik Buterin @VitalikButerin · co-founder, Ethereum

The most consequential reply came from cryptography. Factoring once took time that grew like $2^{n/2}$, until decades of human cleverness produced the number field sieve and cut it to roughly $2^{n^{1/3}}$; that is why keys for RSA (the Rivest-Shamir-Adleman system) are about 400 bytes rather than 64. His question: "What if there are skeletons in the closet like that, both for elliptic curves and lattices, that we are simply not smart enough to discover - but bots soon will be?"

> *"I don't recommend anyone scramble to move their funds to new wallets today. But we should take the risks to cryptography from AI-accelerated math seriously… If AI will bring us 50 years of math in 2 years, then that 50 years of math may very plausibly include a 'naive factoring -> GNFS' level of improvement to our ability to break lattices."*
>
> VITALIK BUTERIN · @VITALIKBUTERIN · POST

GNFS is the general number field sieve. That matters because lattices are the basis of the new "post-quantum" standards, including the Module-Lattice Digital Signature Algorithm (ML-DSA), and of fully homomorphic encryption (FHE). His advice: prefer hash-based schemes wherever they work, which is why Ethereum's "lean" roadmap is going hash-only; for anything lattice-based, "multiply the key sizes by 10"; keep funds in addresses that have never signed a transaction; and gather multi-signature (multisig) wallet approvals off-chain so signatures are not exposed if the Elliptic Curve Digital Signature Algorithm (ECDSA) falls early. In a correction he said each multisig signer should ideally change keys after every operation, and repeated his warning: "it's very easy to lose funds from a misconfigured rushed upgrade, so … don't rush anything." The stakes go "far beyond blockchains": websites, secure messaging, Tor and virtual private networks.

QUICK HIT

Jeff Dean @JeffDean on Margaret Hamilton (Apollo flight software, died at 90): "her contributions to the flight software that got us to the moon are legendary."

BIOLOGY NEXT

Demis Hassabis joins the Virtual Biology Initiative

Demis Hassabis (@demishassabis), CEO of Google DeepMind and Isomorphic Labs, said Isomorphic is a founding member of the Virtual Biology Initiative with the Chan Zuckerberg Initiative, an open resource for disease research: "The most important thing we can apply AI to is improving medicine and human health."

Agents vs. storefronts

Agents are starting to do real chores. The fights now are over who lets them in, how much computing they will eat, and how much access you hand them.

Paul Graham @paulg · co-founder, Y Combinator

> *"Amazon banning agents is the first opportunity I've seen since Amazon was founded for a startup to create an Amazon competitor. People will want agents to buy stuff for them. It will be one of the main use cases. And they won't want to use some Amazon-supplied agent to do it."*
>
> PAUL GRAHAM · @PAULG · POST

The background: since September 20, Amazon has blocked Meta's Muse agent with a pop-up saying "continued access by an unauthorized AI agent violates Amazon's Conditions of Use," after Meta refused to take Amazon out of Muse. Amazon's earlier suit against Perplexity's Comet shopping agent weakened in August, when an appeals court threw out an injunction on the theory that the user, not the toolmaker, is the one accessing Amazon. TechCrunch reports agent blocks at other sites too, some deliberate and some from anti-bot defaults. Graham generalized it: "Any business that bans agents represents an opportunity for a startup to create a competitor. If they need to ban agents, it must mean people want to use them." When someone said the effect only hits a small group, he answered that "it's a group that will gradually expand to include most buyers." Elon Musk quoted the original post with one word: "Seriously."

Aaron Levie and Elon Musk on compute

Ivan Burazin, citing developer Kenneth Auchenberg, estimated that Muse would need 65,000 processors and 75 petabytes of memory to serve 100 million users, "$2.8B in infra for one app." Aaron Levie, CEO of Box, built on it: "The compute needed for the stage of AI we're about to enter is going to be insane… agents that review all of our code for security issues… background agents working on tasks 24/7." Agents need not just tokens but "computers, networking, file systems." Musk replied: "People have no idea."

> QUICK HIT
>
> **Guillermo Rauch** @rauchg cheered Browserbase's web fetch in Vercel's AI Gateway: "Just fetch that works for the whole internet."

Uncle Bob Martin @unclebobmartin · author of *Clean Code*

The software author offered a user's report: "grokbots are just plain amazing. I'm getting all my bills and finances organized to a level I never thought possible." Asked how he hands over bank logins, he said he uses a finance connector that is "read only"; asked about letting an agent read his email, he said his email already "passes through many different servers in many different places. I'm not too concerned about one more." Musk spent much of the night quoting similar testimonials ("Grok @Bot can manage your finances"), and the official account announced that Grok Bot can now "search, read, and monitor X."

Alexandr Wang and Nat Friedman @alexandr_wang · chief AI officer, Meta · @natfriedman · Meta

Meta released a Muse app for iPad ("all that screen real estate for your muse to really spread out in"). When a user asked what happens since Muse can run destructive commands like "rm -rf", Nat Friedman deadpanned: "rm -rf recursively deletes files without asking for confirmation."

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · creator of Ruby on Rails, co-founder of 37signals

He shared his whole coding setup: "any harness, multiple agents concurrently, barely any skills, and using adversarial reviews. There's no magic sauce." The adversarial part: "if I'm driving from Codex: 'Review this with claude'. And when I'm in Claude: 'Review this with codex'. Models know how to kick off a review using the cli. Know how to take turns. Know how to settle an argument." He now often skips his editor: "lazygit plus an agent is now good enough for 95% of the work I do." He also said SpaceXAI is backing Omarchy with Grok tokens.

Phones from space, and a standoff over India

Regulators in Washington cleared SpaceX's biggest phone network yet, while Musk escalated a four-year fight to get Starlink into India.

15,000	150	100×	2035
Next-generation direct-to-phone satellites the FCC approved on October 6	Megabits per second targeted per user, versus about 4 on today's ~650 satellites	Bandwidth Musk says V2 will add over the current system	Deadline to finish the constellation; half must be up by 2032

Elon Musk on Starlink Mobile



A SpaceX Falcon 9 lofting Starlink satellites from Launch Complex 40 on April 21, 2022, as Artemis I and Crew-4 hardware stand on nearby pads at Kennedy Space Center.

PHOTO: NASA/KIM SHIFLETT · PUBLIC DOMAIN

The Federal Communications Commission approved up to 15,000 satellites flying unusually low, about 326 to 335 kilometers up, to connect ordinary phones using T-Mobile spectrum and spectrum SpaceX is buying from EchoStar. A waiver also gives SpaceX a path to sell satellite phone service without leasing spectrum from a ground carrier, which could make it a direct competitor to carriers. SpaceNews notes the larger V2 satellites need Starship and are slated to start launching in 2027.

> *"Starlink Mobile (direct-to-cell) V2 satellites are incredible. This @SpaceX constellation will enable more than 100 times the bandwidth of our current V1 system!"*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

Starlink Mobile also launched in Bangladesh with the carrier Banglalink, letting phones message and share location in cellular dead zones. Musk: "Connectivity leads to prosperity."

Elon Musk on India

DogeDesigner posted figures arguing "India needs Starlink," including that 11,256 villages still lacked 4G coverage in May and that only 4.26% of Indian internet subscriptions are wired. Musk quoted it with his sharpest post of the day, seen more than 60 million times:

> *"Unfortunately, we are being blocked by certain oligarchs in order to maintain their monopolistic chokehold on the Indian people. You can guess who they are … This is a crime against the people of India!"*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

He named no one; CNBC notes that Reliance Jio and Bharti Airtel dominate the market. India's government rejected the charge, saying Starlink, Jio's satellite arm and Eutelsat OneWeb are at the same stage, awaiting security clearance and spectrum. When a user replied that Starlink terminals had been recovered from insurgents in Manipur, Musk wrote that "Starlink beams are turned off over India, so the claim that they were used by anyone for any reason is absolutely false." A data-center veteran who helped launch India's first public internet gateway in 1995 backed Musk, saying he had "personally seen Starlink files sitting under piles of files."

DEFENSE

Palmer Luckey disputes ABC News on Anduril

A day after Anduril's $6.6 billion Baltimore County submarine-parts shipyard was announced, an ABC News analysis said companies backed by Donald Trump Jr.'s venture firm 1789 Capital had won more than $6 billion in contracts. Palmer Luckey (@PalmerLuckey), Anduril's founder, called it false: "1789 Capital has only invested a total of $50M in Anduril, and this so-called 'major stake' is about 1/1000th of the company," and most of the $6 billion is "hypothetical contract ceilings."

PATRONAGE

SpaceXAI funds Omarchy

David Heinemeier Hansson (@dhh) said SpaceXAI is a founding corporate patron of the Omacom Foundation, giving "$1,500,000 in @grok tokens for the maintenance and development of Omarchy," his Linux setup.

CONNECTIVITY

Bangladesh goes live

Starlink Mobile launched with carrier Banglalink so ordinary phones can message and share location in cellular dead zones. Musk: "Connectivity leads to prosperity" and "Starlink connecting Bangladesh!"

AIRLINES

KLM books Starlink Wi-Fi

KLM chief executive officer Marjan Rintel said free Starlink Wi-Fi will roll out on intercontinental flights from mid-2027 for Flying Blue members, with the full wide-body fleet targeted by mid-2028. Musk amplified KLM's announcement: "Starlink coming to KLM!"

QUICK HIT

Elon Musk @elonmusk marked Dragon undocking from the Space Station and posted "Perspicacious path to a petawatt/year." He is due at the White House today for the National Medal of Science.

Takeaways

1. The PC is back in the AI story. Microsoft and Nvidia want agents running locally, in a sandbox, with the cloud as backup.
2. Cheap, fast small models are the new battleground: GPT-6 Luna, Claude Haiku 5.5 and a promised fast Grok 4.8.
3. Assistants are becoming routers that pick the right model per request. Open-weight fine-tunes want a slice too.
4. Brown's threshold argument explains why AI math feels sudden. Chollet's human evidence says don't assume it spreads.
5. Buterin's warning is the sleeper: if AI speeds up math, today's "safe" encryption may need much bigger keys.
6. Agent shopping is now a fight over access. Graham sees an opening for whoever lets agents in.

On the beat

POSTED · 24

Elon Musk, Uncle Bob Martin, Palmer Luckey, Yann LeCun, David Heinemeier Hansson, Paul Graham, Guillermo Rauch, Satya Nadella, Jensen Huang, Vitalik Buterin, Clément Delangue, Alexandr Wang, Jeff Dean, François Chollet, Lisa Su, Tobi Lütke, Noam Brown, Sam Altman, Greg Brockman, Tom Brown, Demis Hassabis, Jim Fan, Joe Gebbia, Nat Friedman.

WATCH LIST

Added Mark Chen (@markchen90), OpenAI chief research officer. The list now stands at 43.

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Marc Andreessen, Ashok Elluswamy, Andrej Karpathy, Dario Amodei, John Carmack, Patrick Collison, Fei-Fei Li, Mustafa Suleyman, Andrew Ng, Michael Truell, Mira Murati, Mark Zuckerberg, David Singleton, Ilya Sutskever, Sundar Pichai, Kanjun Qiu, Arthur Mensch, Guillaume Lample.

Also on the wire

Jim Fan @DrJimFan: "humanity will solve the Riemann hypothesis before we pass the Physical Turing Test" — a robot that cleans up after a party so well you can't tell it wasn't a person.

Paul Graham @paulg: after talking to Replit's Amjad Masad, AI's "deepest change takes the form of code." Also: "Any business that bans agents represents an opportunity for a startup to create a competitor."

Guillermo Rauch @rauchg on agent loops: "Even in an infinite token world, you need to know when to stop... Agents will happily drill no matter what."

Yann LeCun @ylecun on automated proof: "The invention of the boat reduced the importance of swimming, but allowed the discovery of new lands." post

Noam Brown @polynoamial: models have crossed above top human experts on some research problems, but capabilities "remain jagged."

Mark Chen @markchen90 on the Navier-Stokes run: "a decade of mathematical progress in a week," aimed next at life sciences, next models, and alignment.

Nat Friedman @natfriedman on Muse and shell commands: "rm -rf recursively deletes files without asking for confirmation."

François Chollet @fchollet: programming gains "do not transfer to general cognitive tasks."

Sam Altman @sama on Intelligent UI: "I would hate to have to go back to the old version of Chat!"

Aaron Levie on agent compute needing "computers, networking, file systems." Musk: "People have no idea."

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